

Integrated Pest Management Plan



The
Voluntary
Initiative

VI IPM Assessment Plan

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Thank you for completing the plan, please print off this plan for your reference.
A summary of your responses is listed below.

Your plan score: 105.17749794%

Below are some suggestions on how you could improve your IPM strategy:

Which crop types are in your rotation?

- A broader rotation allows a greater range of crop types and sowing dates which can break up pest life cycles and provide opportunities for different methods of pest control. As an example, spring cropping provides a greater control window for autumn germinating weeds. The presence of some pests and soil-borne diseases can be reduced by limiting the frequency of susceptible host crops. A wider, more diverse rotation can also allow for greater biodiversity, which can encourage the presence of beneficial insects. A diverse range of root types and structures can improve soil structure and nutrient availability, encouraging the growth of stronger, healthier plants.
- Adding a brassica to the rotation increases diversity, and can provide the ability to select alternative PPPs.

If you typically use an arable rotation, why do you do this?

- A diverse range of root types and structures across the rotation(including cover crops) can improve soil compaction, microbiology, organic content, drainage, water holding capacity, pH and nutrient availability.Improving soil health and structure encourages crop establishment, boosting competitiveness against certain weeds.
-

What factors have you considered when choosing crop variety grown for this cropping year?

- Certain varieties are better suited to different climate conditions, for example showing greater disease resistance in wetter areas or drought tolerance. Climatic conditions can affect factors such as pest and disease pressure, lodging risk and ripening date. Appropriate variety selection can protect yield and quality and reduce the need for PPPs. Varieties are available for some crops that can show resistance to certain insect pests such as OWBM and aphids. If appropriate for your farm, this can reduce the need for PPP applications
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-

Which management measures will you employ to prevent/control weeds on your farm this cropping year?

- Precision herbicide application, for example through patch spraying or the use of weed wipers can reduce the amount of herbicide used. It can also reduce the risk of weed resistance developing.
 - Selective herbicides can be applied to control specific weeds at no detriment to the cash crop, such as broadleaved weeds in a cereal crop, thus reducing weed competition and weed seed return. Care must be taken to follow best practice in any herbicide application to reduce the risk of herbicide resistance.
-

For each of your most economically important crops, which management measures will you employ to prevent/control insect pests/slugs and disease this cropping year?

- If a field has a history of a certain disease like clubroot or take-all, it may present a problem in the future, either through survival in the soil, on the soil surface or via the 'green bridge'. Knowledge of field history is therefore important for disease control. Wetter fields are often more prone to diseases, due to poor plant growth as well as some pathogens (e.g. take-all) favouring high soil moisture. Soil nutrient deficiencies, suboptimal pH, adverse seed bed conditions and poor drainage are also likely to increase the risk of disease.
 - When growing potatoes, ensuring a crop isn't grown on land with a heavy presence of certain soil pathogens that pose a significant risk to that crop can help ensure healthy cropping with a reduced need for fungicide applications.
-

What factors have you considered when developing/evaluating your IPM plan?

- Maps of historical pest problems can provide valuable information on potential pest populations on a field-by-field basis. Some pests and diseases can survive in soil, while others only increase when their host crop is grown too often in the same field. This information can be used when planning e.g. crop locations, varieties and cultivations.
-

Which of the following sources of IPM advice have you considered when creating/evaluating your IPM plan?

- Open days and crops walks provide an opportunity to see how pest control measures are being implemented on other local farms that likely share the same geography, soil types and climate conditions. They also provide the opportunity to discuss strategies with other farmers as well as researchers and advisers and gain practical advice and guidance.
-

Which crop types are in your rotation?

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- Adding a brassica to the rotation increases diversity, and can provide the ability to select alternative PPPs.

If you typically use an arable rotation, why do you do this?

- A diverse range of root types and structures across the rotation(including cover crops) can improve soil compaction, microbiology, organic content, drainage, water holding capacity, pH and nutrient availability.Improving soil health and structure encourages crop establishment, boosting competitiveness against certain weeds.

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For each of your most economically important crops, which management measures will you employ to prevent/control insect pests/slugs and disease this cropping year?

- If a field has a history of a certain disease like clubroot or take-all, it may present a problem in the future, either through survival in the soil, on the soil surface or via the 'green bridge'. Knowledge of field history is therefore important for disease control. Wetter fields are often more prone to diseases, due to poor plant growth as well as some pathogens (e.g. take-all) favouring high soil moisture. Soil nutrient deficiencies, suboptimal pH, adverse seed bed conditions and poor drainage are also likely to increase the risk of disease.
- When growing potatoes, ensuring a crop isn't grown on land with a heavy presence of certain soil pathogens that pose a significant risk to that crop can help ensure healthy cropping with a reduced need for fungicide applications.

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Which of the following sources of IPM advice have you considered when creating/evaluating your IPM plan?

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Your responses:

IPM is a whole farm approach to pest management that maximises productivity whilst minimising negative impacts on the environment. It is an integrated approach that maximises the benefits of all methods of pest control, including physical, chemical, biological and cultural. A pest refers to any harmful organism (including weeds, fungi, bacteria, virus, slugs, insects, nematodes).

1 - How familiar are you with Integrated Pest Management (IPM)?

- Very familiar

Please select one option

For example, growing them on the same land for 5 or more consecutive years without growing a non-cereal break crop such as oilseed rape, beans, peas, grass.

2 - What proportion of the land that you farm or manage is in continuous barley or winter wheat production.

- 1 - 25%

Please select one option

3 - Which crop types are in your rotation?

- Spring cereals
- Winter cereals
- Oilseeds
- Temporary grass ley

Please select all that apply, including cash, trap, cover crops etc.

4 - If you typically use an arable rotation, why do you do this?

Check this box if you do not use a rotation, you wont need to answer the rest of this question.

- No response

To control weeds

- Strongly agree

To control disease

- Strongly agree

To control insect pests, nematodes, slugs and snails

- Strongly agree

To improve or maintain soil structure and fertility

- Strongly agree

To spread costs and financial risks

- Strongly agree

Largely because it's necessary to comply with a scheme or contractual obligations

- Strongly Disagree

Please select one option per row

An IPM strategy is a coordinated and planned strategy for the prevention, detection and control of pests. An IPM strategy is tailored to farm business needs and can be adapted frequently to reflect changing challenges to plant health on farm.

5 - Do you consider cultivations as part of your IPM strategy?

- Yes

Please indicate what cultivations you do?

- Non-inversion (minimum) tillage
- Direct drilling (no tillage)

Estimate the % of cultivated land that is currently ploughed.

- 0

Please select all that apply.

6 - Name the specific weeds, diseases, insect, nematode or slug pests which you see as being of the greatest concern to crop production on the land that you farm.

- Barley yellow dwarf virus (BYDV)
- Black grass
- Sterile brome
- No response
- No response

You do not need to fill in all boxes

7 - Are there any crops that used to be a regular part of your business, but that you have stopped growing/significantly reduced area grown in the past 5 years due to plant health reasons and why?

Crop 1

- Oilseed rape - winter

Crop 2

- Beans - spring field beans

Crop 3

- Linseed - winter

If this question is not relevant to your business, please move on to the next question

Loss of PPPs

- Crop 1

Insect/slug pressure

- Crop 1

Weed pressure

- No response

Disease pressure

- No response

Climate conditions becoming unsuitable

- Crop 2

Adviser recommendation

- No response

Unreliable yield

- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Changing market requirements/prices

- No response

Unreliable quality

- No response

8 - Which of the following statements best describes your relationship with your agronomist/crop protection adviser?

- We decide on the pest management strategy together

Please select one answer

9 - What, if anything, is most preventing you from increasing uptake of IPM practices?

- Nothing/none of these

Please select all that apply.

10 - What is your position on the farm?

- Tenant

Please select all that apply.

11 - How much land do you farm under the following categories?

Not organic Conventional?

Biodiversity scheme

- 50

Arable

- 400

Grassland

- 100

Rough grazing

- 50

Fallow

- 0

Land Ownership

Owned?

- 10

Rented / leased?

- 70

Contract farmed?

- 20
-

12 - Please enter your age

- 49
-

13 - How many years have you worked in agriculture?

- 30
-

14 - Please select your county

- Oxfordshire
-

15 - Do you have a farming qualification?

- NRoSO
- National Spray Proficiency Test (NSPT)/PA qualifications
- National Diploma

Please select all that apply.

Countryside Stewardship, LEAF, SFI, AECS.

16 - Are you involved in a scheme/initiative that aims to enhance biodiversity?

- Yes

If yes, please make a selection below

- Countryside Stewardship
-

17 - Are you a member of an assurance scheme?

- Yes

If yes, please make a selection below.

- Red Tractor
-

Plant protection products, including fungicides, herbicides, insecticides, nematicides, slug control agents and plant growth regulators

18 - Do you pay an agronomist for crop protection advice or is it incorporated into the price for PPPs?

- I pay an agronomist for crop protection advice

Please select all that apply

The three different crops you grow that provide the most economic value to your business.

19 - What is the predominate soil type for the three most economically important crops you grow?

Crop 1

- Wheat - winter

Crop 2

- Barley - winter

Crop 3

- Wheat - spring

Medium

- No response

Organic/peat/soils

- No response

Clay

- No response

Silt

- No response

Sand

- No response

Other (please specify)

- chalk/flint
- chalk/flint
- chalk/flint

Please select one soil type for each crop. **The crops that you select above will be used in later questions**

The three different crops you grow that provide the most economic value to your business.

20 - What factors have you considered when choosing crops grown for this cropping year?

End market

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Soil type

- No response

Contribution to rotation despite a less than desirable gross margin

- No response

Pest/weed/disease prevention

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Pest/weed/disease control

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Gross margin

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Reliability

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Availability of PPPs

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Availability of equipment/ machinery

- No response

Adviser recommendation

- No response

Cash flow

- No response

Reduced reliance on inputs

- No response

local climate conditions

- No response

Tolerance of a wide range of weather conditions

- No response

Crop storage

- No response

Availability of labour

- No response

Other (please specify)

- No response

Please select all factors that apply for the 3 most **economically important crops you will grow**

The three different crops you grow that provide the most economic value to your business.

21 - What factors have you considered when choosing crop variety grown for this cropping year?

Recommended lists (where available)

- Crop 1
- Crop 2

Availability of seed

- No response

Price of seed

- No response

Adviser recommendation

- No response

End-market

- Crop 1
- Crop 3

Gross margin

- No response

Disease resistance

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Weed competitiveness

- Crop 1
- Crop 2
- Crop 3

Yield potential

- Crop 1
- Crop 2

Quality potential

- Crop 1
- Crop 3

Reliability

- Crop 1

Local climate conditions

- Crop 1

Insect pest tolerance

- Crop 2

Other (Please specify)

- No response

Please select all factors that apply for the 3 most economically important crops you will grow

22 - Which management measures will you employ to prevent/control weeds on your farm this cropping year?

Stale/false seedbeds

- Adopted

Full inversion ploughing

- No response

Use of a non-selective herbicide (for example, glyphosate) pre-sowing

- Adopted

Use of a non-selective herbicide (for example, glyphosate) pre-harvest for weed control

- No response

Ensure control measures are used at the optimum time

- Adopted

Selective application of herbicide (for example, precision farming or weed-wiper)

- No response

Crop/weed destruction before seeds are viable

- No response

Hand weeding or non-chemical weed destruction (for example, use of a weed surfer)

- No response

Manage cropped headlands/surrounding vegetation to prevent weed ingress from non-cropped areas

- Adopted

Regular cleaning of harvesting and cultivation equipment and/or ensuring areas with high weed levels are harvested last

- Adopted

Choose competitive varieties

- Adopted

Adjust drilling dates where appropriate

- Adopted

Set action thresholds

- No response

Use lower than label recommended dose where appropriate

- No response

Use a selective herbicide

- No response

Use of a rotation

- Adopted

Frequent crop inspections to monitor weed pressures

- Adopted

Adopting crop management measures (such as increasing seeding rate)

- Adopted

Consider site selection (factors such as weed burden, soil type, drainage)

- Adopted

Other (please specify)

- No response

Please make one selection per row

23 - For each of your most economically important crops, which management measures will you employ to prevent/control insect pests/slugs and disease this cropping year?

To prevent/control disease

Grow resistant varieties

- Adopted

Optimising nutrition

- Adopted

Use certified seed

- Adopted

Test non-certified seed and treat if required

- No response

Regularly test soils for pathogens

- No response

Use seed treatments where available

- Adopted

Consider disease forecasts

- No response

Use on-farm disease modelling

- No response

Use of a rotation

- Adopted

Adjust drilling dates where appropriate

- Adopted

Set action thresholds

- No response

Use lower than label recommended dose where appropriate

- No response

Implement good biosecurity practices such as removing/destroying affected plant material and frequently cleaning equipment

- No response

Consider site selection (factors such as field history, soil type, drainage)

- No response

Frequent crop inspections to monitor disease pressures

- Adopted

Other (please specify)

- No response

To prevent/control insects pests/slugs

Encourage natural enemies (for example, ladybirds) through provision of habitats

- Adopted

Use selective chemical controls where possible (minimising use of broad-spectrum insecticides)

- Adopted

Consider site selection (factors such as pest burdens)

- No response

Optimising nutrition

- Adopted

Use seed treatments

- No response

Cultivations for control of slugs (preparation of fine, consolidated seedbed, rolling)

- No response

Use of a rotation

- Adopted

Regularly monitor above ground pest populations

- Adopted

Consider pest forecasts

- No response

Adjust drilling dates where appropriate

- Adopted

Set action thresholds

- Adopted

Use lower than label recommended dose where appropriate

- No response

Regularly test for nematodes

- No response

Regularly monitor for insect pests

- Adopted

Remove/bury/destroy crop residues and weeds that can act as pest hosts

- No response

Frequently clean equipment and implement good biosecurity practices

- No response

Frequent crop inspections to monitor pest populations

- Adopted

Other (please specify)

- No response

Please make one selection per row

24 - For each of your most economically important crops, which management measures will you employ to prevent/control insect pests/slugs and disease this cropping year?

To prevent/control disease

Grow resistant varieties

- Adopted

Optimising nutrition

- Adopted

Use certified seed

- Adopted

Test non-certified seed and treat if required

- No response

Regularly test soils for pathogens

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Use seed treatments where available

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Consider disease forecasts

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Other (please specify)

- No response

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Other (please specify)

- No response

Please make one selection per row

27 - Do you currently/plan to use any Decision Support System (DSS) (including Recommended Lists)?

- Yes
- AHDB Recommended Lists for cereals and oilseeds

If you are aware of a DSS (Including Recommended Lists) being available for a crop you grow, but you do not use it, why?

- No response
-

Plant protection products, including fungicides, herbicides, insecticides, nematicides, slug control agents and plant growth regulators

28 - Which specific facilities or procedures to minimise movement of PPPs to watercourses or to groundwater will you use?

During filling and cleaning out the sprayer

- Use of a closed-transfer system when filling the sprayer and cleaning containers

Field operations

- Choice of crop or PPP
- Minimising spray drift (for example, through the use of low drift (3*/4*) nozzles, adjusting boom height, forward speed)
- Section control of sprayer
- Use of buffer strips
- Management of tramlines
- I am involved in a water company scheme to protect water quality
- There are no watercourses on or immediately adjoining the land farmed or managed

Please select all that apply

29 - What factors have you considered when developing/evaluating your IPM plan?

- Crop inspection data from previous crops, used to assess the performance of various control measures
- Technical research on efficacy of PPPs and cultural control measures
- Advice from agronomist/crop protection adviser
- Yield maps or information, used to identify areas requiring specific attention
- Cost-benefit analysis of management options
- End-market requirements
- Variety resistance
- Availability of effective PPPs
- Presence of soil borne diseases, nematodes and insects (including slugs)
- Position of each crop in your planned rotation
- PPP anti-resistance strategies
- Considering impact of drilling dates
- Emerging insect pest/slug/weed/disease problems on your farm, or in the local area
- Results of IPM trials from monitor and demonstration farms

Please select all that apply

30 - Which of the following sources of IPM advice have you considered when creating/evaluating your IPM plan?

- Farmer discussion groups
- Other farmers (not including discussion groups)
- Independent agronomist
- Evaluating previous control strategies used on your farm
- Farming press
- Online resources (for example, the [Voluntary Initiative](#), quality assurance scheme information)
- Information and updates from membership, levy and research organisations

Please select all that apply

An adviser with a BASIS Certificate in Crop Protection

31 - Are you BASIS qualified, or have you completed this plan alongside a BASIS qualified adviser?

- No response

If Yes, please answer the following

- No response
-